

The mass of the electron as an electromagnetic effect

by David Jonsson, Uppsala , Sweden

Take a look at the equation for the magnetic flux around a moving electron in the nonrelativistic case, the simple Biot-Savarts law

$$\bar{\mathbf{B}} = \frac{\mu_0 e}{4\pi} \frac{\bar{\mathbf{v}} \times \bar{\mathbf{r}}}{r^3} \quad (1)$$

The energy-density of this field is according to eq. (2)

$$u = \frac{\bar{\mathbf{B}}^2}{2\mu_0} \quad (\bar{\mathbf{B}}^2 = \bar{\mathbf{B}} \cdot \bar{\mathbf{B}}) \quad (2)$$

In order to calculate the magnetic energy of the moving electron we insert (1) into (2) to get (3).

$$u = \frac{\mu_0 e^2}{32\pi^2} \frac{v^2 \sin^2 \theta}{r^4} \quad (3)$$

Lets integrate eq. (3) outside the electron to find out the entire energy of its magnetic field.

$$U = \frac{\mu_0 e^2}{12\pi} \frac{v^2}{r_e} \quad (4)$$

Lets install the classical electron radius r_e ,

$$r_e = \frac{e^2}{4\pi \epsilon_0 c^2 m_e} = \frac{\mu_0 e^2}{4\pi m_e} \quad (5)$$

in (4) to get

$$U = \frac{m_e v^2}{3} \quad (6)$$

This reminds very much of the equation of the kinetic energy of the electron. Only 1/6 of the kinetic energy is missing but remember that I haven't included the field inside the electron in the calculus. Can it be so simple that the inertia of the electron is due to Lenz' law?